# Mentoring Notes — Problem Analysis in BCC

## 1. Main Diagnosis

The main issue with the previous problem analysis was not effort, but direction. The analysis looked polished and used many frameworks, but the core business problem was not clearly framed. The issue tree did not clearly show what kind of business problem LRT City Sentul was facing.

A strong BCC problem framing should clarify whether the case is mainly about:

- money or profitability,
- product-market fit,
- market or competition,
- internal capability, HR, or process,
- investment or expansion decision.

In this case, the problem was likely a product-market fit problem: how LRT City Sentul can make its product and services fit better with student needs. However, the existing framing did not make that clear enough.

The previous problem framing was too general. It talked about making LRT City Sentul more “credible” as a student-friendly ecosystem, but it did not narrow down whether credibility should be solved through product, marketing, service design, pricing, operations, or mobility.

## 2. Problem Framing Feedback

The problem statement should be more specific and business-transferrable.

Instead of framing the problem as:

> “How can LRT City Sentul become a credible student-friendly living ecosystem?”

A stronger framing would be closer to:

> “How can LRT City Sentul redesign its housing product and service offering to achieve stronger product-market fit with students, despite its distance disadvantage?”

The word “credible” is too vague unless it is explained through a business function. Credible through what? Product? Pricing? Marketing? Operations? Mobility? Parent trust? The framing must force a specific analytical direction.

The issue tree should not place “weak student fit” as one branch because weak student fit is the entire problem. The sub-problems should explain where the product-market fit breaks down, such as affordability, mobility, safety, study environment, parent trust, or service reliability.

## 3. Issue Tree Feedback

The issue tree was not fully MECE. It mixed symptoms, causes, and solution areas in the same layer.

A better issue tree should break down the product-market fit problem into clear dimensions. For example:

Main problem:

> LRT City Sentul has weak product-market fit with students.

Possible sub-problems:

1. Affordability fit
   Are the pricing, payment scheme, and monthly cost structure suitable for student cash flow?

2. Mobility fit
   Does the location disadvantage become acceptable through reliable access, shuttle, LRT linkage, or commute comfort?

3. Safety and trust fit
   Does the offer satisfy both students and parents as decision influencers?

4. Daily routine fit
   Does the housing support actual student routines: studying, resting, laundry, food, Wi-Fi, privacy, and flexibility?

5. Competitive fit
   Why would students choose LRT City Sentul over kost, campus-proximate housing, apartments, or coliving?

The Kano Model was useful because it helped identify which factors students see as basic expectations versus performance features. The issue tree should have been built more directly from these factors.

## 4. Insight Quality Feedback

Many insights were too obvious. They sounded correct, but not unique enough to win.

Example of weak insight:

> “Students need daily life to be easier, safer, and more practical.”

This is too generic. The opposite would be:

> “Students want daily life to be harder, more dangerous, and less practical.”

That opposite makes no sense, so the original insight is too obvious.

A useful test for insight quality:

> Flip the insight into its opposite. If the opposite makes no sense, the insight is probably too generic.

A stronger insight would be something like:

> “Although students are the intended users, parents may still act as the real decision-makers because they fund the rent and care most about safety, trust, and operational reliability.”

This is more specific because the opposite could still make sense:

> “Students are the sole decision-makers, and parents do not strongly influence housing choice.”

That is debatable, so the insight is more meaningful.

## 5. What Makes an Insight Strong

A strong BCC insight must be specific to:

- the case,
- the customer segment,
- the client’s situation,
- the business problem,
- the strategic decision.

For this case, the insight should be specific to:

- students,
- LRT City Sentul,
- Sentul’s location disadvantage,
- housing and well-being,
- the gap between apartment and kost alternatives.

The analysis was too broad. A lot of the insights could apply to almost any apartment or housing product. A strong insight should explain what is uniquely true about students choosing LRT City Sentul.

Possible stronger insight direction:

> “The core barrier may not be that LRT City Sentul lacks facilities, but that its location creates a distance friction that students will only accept if the total living experience feels safer, more predictable, and more parent-approved than kost alternatives.”

This is more case-specific because it connects student needs, LRT City Sentul's location, and the competitive alternative.

## 6. White Space Analysis Feedback

The white space analysis was too obvious because the axes were too generic.

If the map simply shows that students want affordable, safe, convenient, and supportive housing, it does not create a new strategic understanding. The analysis must explain why moving into the new position matters, why competitors cannot already occupy it, and why LRT City Sentul has the right to win there.

A stronger white space analysis should answer:

- What do students care about most?
- What do parents care about most?
- What does LRT City Sentul uniquely have?
- What does LRT City Sentul uniquely lack?
- Why is its distance disadvantage not fatal?
- What trade-off would make students accept living farther away?

## 7. Framework Feedback

The biggest warning was framework dumping.

Frameworks are not the point. Frameworks only matter if they produce new insights or guide decisions. If the team enters a framework without a clear direction, the output becomes exposition: "framework A says this, framework B says that," but the judge still does not know the main problem.

The better approach is top-down:

1. State the main problem.
2. State the main insight.
3. Use frameworks only to prove or stress-test that insight.
4. Connect each framework to the recommendation.

Bad structure:

> "We used framework A, then framework B, then framework C."

Better structure:

> "The core problem is weak student product-market fit caused by distance friction, affordability concerns, and parent trust. Our survey, Kano Model, competitor mapping, and interviews all validate this."

The heading should be the insight, not the framework name.

## 8. Survey and Research Feedback

Survey questions should avoid hypothetical questions.

Weak survey questions:

- “Would you use this product?”
- “Would you like this feature?”
- “Would you be interested in living here?”

These are weak because respondents often answer aspirationally, not behaviorally.

Better survey questions ask about historical behavior:

- “Where do you currently live?”
- “Who influenced your housing decision?”
- “How long is your current commute?”
- “What was the biggest reason you chose your current housing?”
- “Have you ever rejected a housing option because it was too far?”
- “How much do your parents influence your housing decision?”
- “What monthly cost range is acceptable?”
- “What trade-off would make you accept living farther from campus?”

If testing a product concept, break it into attributes rather than asking directly whether they like the product.

For example, test:

- shuttle availability,
- all-in pricing,
- parent monitoring or trust features,
- Wi-Fi reliability,
- study space,
- safety system,
- laundry or food bundle,
- flexible payment.

## 9. Solution Fit Feedback

Some solutions did not connect strongly enough to the analysis.

SAVA was seen as weakly grounded because the analysis did not clearly show that complaint handling, information access, or apartment request management was a major student pain point. If a problem was never diagnosed, the solution feels random even if it sounds useful.

PASTI Bundle sounded better, but the narration needed to be stronger.

The shuttle or mobility-related solution was stronger because it directly addressed the location and distance friction. This is the type of solution that should have been emphasized more because it connects clearly to the likely core problem.

The key principle:

> Problem-solution fit must be extremely obvious.

If the problem is location friction, the solution must clearly reduce location friction.
If the problem is parent trust, the solution must clearly build parent trust.
If the problem is affordability, the solution must clearly change the cost equation.
If the problem is student routine, the solution must clearly improve daily routine.

## 10. Marketing Solution Feedback

The marketing solution was considered acceptable. However, marketing should not be the main answer unless the problem is clearly proven to be a perception or communication problem.

For LRT City Sentul, the stronger problem may not be marketing. It may be product-market fit, especially because the location is far. Therefore, marketing should support the product strategy, not replace it.

## 11. Top-Down Communication Feedback

The proposal was not top-down enough.

The current structure felt like:

> “This framework gives this result, then this framework gives this result, then another framework gives another result.”

A stronger structure should feel like:

> “This is the main problem. These analyses prove it. These are the few insights that matter. These solutions directly answer those insights.”

Judges skim first. They usually read headings and main insights before checking the methodology. If the insight is interesting, then they stress-test the appendix, survey, and framework logic.

Therefore, slide titles and section headings should be insight-based.

Weak heading:

> “Survey Analysis”

Strong heading:

> “Students may tolerate distance only when the housing offer reduces total daily uncertainty.”

Weak heading:

> “Competitor Analysis”

Strong heading:

> “Kost wins on proximity and affordability, so LRT City Sentul must win through managed reliability and parent trust.”

Weak heading:

> “Kano Model”

Strong heading:

> “Students will not value lifestyle facilities until basic reliability is proven.”

## 12. Main Lessons to Internalize

The main lesson is that BCC problem analysis is not about using many frameworks. It is about producing a few sharp, non-obvious, case-specific insights that lead directly to strong recommendations.

Important principles:

1. Start with the business problem, not the framework.
2. Clarify whether the case is about money, product-market fit, market, internal capability, or investment.
3. Make the issue tree MECE.
4. Separate symptoms, causes, and solutions.
5. Use frameworks to generate insights, not to decorate the proposal.
6. Test every insight by flipping it into its opposite.
7. Avoid obvious insights that apply to everyone.
8. Make insights specific to the client, customer, and case context.
9. Use historical behavior questions in surveys.
10. Ensure every solution directly solves a diagnosed problem.
11. Write top-down so judges can understand the main argument by skimming.
12. Use insight-based headings instead of framework-based headings.

## 13. Practical Next Step for Revision

The revision should start from the problem framing, not from redesigning slides.

Recommended next steps:

1. Reframe the case as a product-market fit problem.
2. Define the main product-market fit gap.
3. Rebuild the issue tree around the biggest reasons students may not choose LRT City Sentul.
4. Identify which problems are most supported by evidence.
5. Rewrite insights so they are more specific to students, parents, location, and LRT City Sentul.
6. Remove or deprioritize frameworks that do not create new insight.
7. Reconnect each solution to one diagnosed problem.
8. Rewrite headings into insight statements.
9. Make the proposal easier for judges to skim.
10. Put methodology and supporting details in the appendix, not the main storyline.

## 14. Sharpest Takeaway

The problem was not that the analysis lacked frameworks. The problem was that the frameworks did not produce enough specific, surprising, and case-relevant insights.

The goal of problem analysis is not to show that students need affordable, safe, and convenient housing. Everyone already knows that.

The goal is to answer:

> “What specific friction prevents this specific target market from choosing this specific client, and what must the client change to overcome it better than alternatives?”